parotid glands; another pair placed beneath the tongue, called sublingual; and the third, or submaxillary, placed near the angles of the lower jaw.

The fluids secreted from these three sets of glands differ in character, but in combination form saliva. A certain portion of saliva is always found in the mouth, except its flow is restrained by disease, but, like the gastric juice of the stomach, the moment food is presented to the mouth the flow is greatly increased, and this sometimes occurs even when the thought of food excites the nerves which supply the salivary glands. This result is what is vulgarly called "setting the mouth watering" at the sight or mention of desirable food. After the food has been duly masticated and moistened by the saliva, it is collected by the muscles of the cheeks and the action of the tongue, and conveyed against the back part or veil of the palate, which is so hung as to close the cavity of the mouth in rest, yet in swallowing to open it freely and permit the passage of the food into the pharynx.

The œsophagus is an elastic muscular tube resembling the trachea in construction, inclosed on its external surface by a serous membrane; then follows a layer of thick elastic muscular membrane, the whole being lined with mucous membrane.

By the muscular contractions of the œsophagus, the food is next forced through an orifice near the heart, surrounded with a strong band, or sphincter, into the main digestive cavity, or stomach.

The human stomach is an oblong membranous bag, situated just below the diaphragm, and placed